

Ethical Dilemmas in AI

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The tension within Scenario B lives between Authentic Learning and Dependency (Almarzouqi et al., pp. 190–191) and Fairness (Chan, pp. 128–129). Specifically, there's a need to protect academic integrity without hurting a student because of an unreliable AI analyzer.

The major LLM companies are already addressing this tension, and how they do it indicates what they value. For instance, Gemini (Dathathri et al., 2024) and Claude now watermark their text, which causes the produced prose to be machine-detectable (Anthropic, 2026). This is most likely attributable to the increasing pressure of regulations, such as those passed by the EU (AI Act, Art. 50(2)), which indicates a desire to maintain access to EU markets. In contrast, OpenAI has not included similar watermarks for their text citing easy circumvention of the watermarks and bias against non-English speakers (OpenAI, 2024). I speculate that this is a strategy to corner non-EU markets.

Bias is a real concern, though, and it's corroborated by Code.org's fourth session of AI 101 for Teachers (28:52). Also, Anthropic concedes that a watermark can't differentiate between an AI's prose and its editing (Anthropic, 2026). We can conclude, then, that Scenario B's 60% flag ought to be taken with caution.

The other stakeholder considered in this analysis is the educator, whose perspective can take two forms. The first is Almarzouqi's productive struggle argument (p. 191). The other is that AI is here to stay and no detector is reasonably reliable to indicate actual student engagement with material.

The job is to adjust teaching rather than police AI use. Instead of punishing a student because of an AI detector score, it's better to talk with the student and allow her to talk through the argument. Doing so will inject accountability into the situation and can function as a check for whether the student was cognitively engaged (Chan, pp. 150–151). Going forward, the university should require an attribution statement (Chan, Fig. 5.4, p. 149). Admittedly, this process isn't perfect, but that doesn't mean we should leave it behind.

References

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